



4 Add soil from the pot, firmly but gently. Any excess water will drip down through the charcoal, but the stones below will prevent your jungle becoming a soggy bog!



5 Spray the leaves with water, and also pour a little water into the soil to make it damp. Your jungle ecosystem is ready to be closed off from the rest of the world.



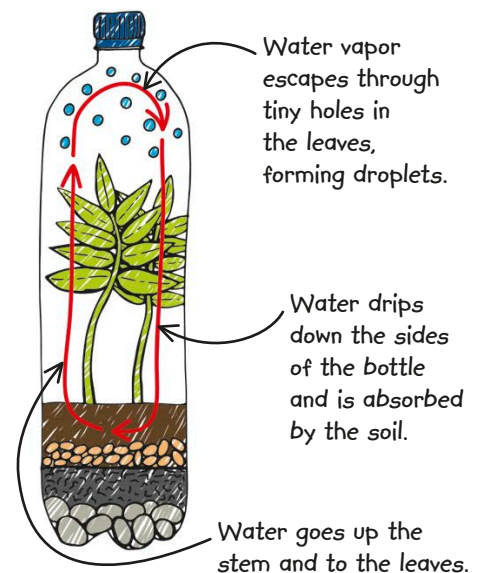
6 Now place the top part of the bottle on the base. This is the last time any air or water will get into or out of the bottle. Then seal the join between the two parts of the bottle with masking tape.



7 Put your jungle somewhere light and in a warm place—but not in direct sunlight. If the bottle gets too warm, the water will evaporate from the bottom of the bottle, rather than passing up through the plant.

HOW IT WORKS

In the natural world, during daytime, water constantly passes through plants in a process called transpiration. The water moves up from the roots and out through tiny holes in the leaves (as invisible vapor). This turns into water droplets that form clouds. In your jungle, the vapor becomes droplets on the inside of the bottle. The water drops onto the soil, like rain, and the cycle begins again.



REAL WORLD SCIENCE AMAZON RAIN FOREST



The proper term for a jungle is tropical rain forest. Tropical means “near the equator.” These forests are always very misty. Each tree sucks up hundreds of gallons of water a day. The air is always full of water vapor—and it rains a lot.